H-B-531c

November 16, 1962

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. H-B-00531b (COM-NBS)
March 25, 1960,
Emergency Fed. Spec. H-B-0531a
August 10, 1951, and
Fed. Spec. H-B-531a
January 22, 1948

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BRUSH, SCRUB, DECK

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. Deck scrubbing brushes covered by this specification are primarily for use in scrubbing decks of seagoing ships. It may also be used to scrub floors, walls, rugs, tables, benches, etc., where a long-handle scrubbing brush is suitable.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Grade and types.* Deck scrubbing brushes covered by this specification shall be of but one grade and of the following types as specified in the invitation for bids.

Type I—Without handles.
Type II—With handles (wood).

2. SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D.C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard sample. Unless otherwise specified in the invitation to bid, a standard sample shall be maintained by the procurement office. Brushes shall be equal to the standard sample in workmanship and balance; stiffness, solidity, and quality of fiber; and in any other respects not specifically covered by this specification (6.3).

3.2 Design. The brushes shall be of the general design illustrated in figure 1.

3.3 Material.

3.3.1 *Fiber.* The fiber shall be 100 percent natural palmyra.

FSC 7920

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3.3.2 *Block.* The block shall be of close-grain hardwood.

3.3.3 *Handle.* The handle of type II brushes shall be of close-grain hardwood free from defects which might impair its strength.

3.3.4 *Staples.* The staples shall be made of corrosion resisting wire or wire made corrosion resisting by a suitable plating. The diameter of the wire in the staples shall be not less than 0.047 inch.

3.4 Construction.

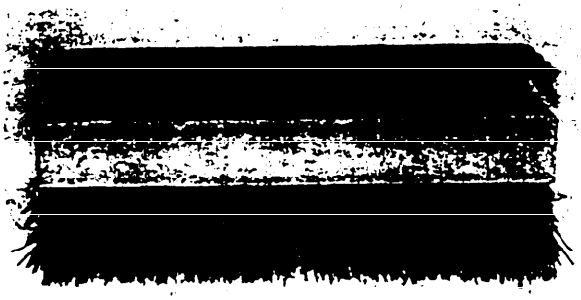


FIGURE 1

3.4.1 *Block.* The block shall be smoothly sanded, filled, and finished with varnish, lacquer, or other suitable transparent organic finish. The side edges shall be chamfered one-half of an inch back at an angle of 45 degrees. The hole for the handle shall be bored through the chamfer at an angle such that in use the brush may be used with facility and effectiveness. The hole for the handle shall be tapered in the same ratio as the block end of the handle (3.4.2) and shall fit the handle closely.

3.4.2 *Handle.* When type II brushes are specified, the handle shall be smoothly finished, straight, rounded at the hand end, and tapered at the block end to ¼-inch diameter in a length of 3 inches from the end.

3.4.3 *Set.* The fiber shall fill the holes solidly in the block and shall be securely staple-set with ½-inch wire staples straddled over the middle of the tuft and driven into the block at the bottom of the hole.

3.5 Physical requirements. The brushes shall conform to the physical requirements in table I.

TABLE I.—*Physical requirements*

Block:	
Length, minimum, inches	9¾
Width, minimum, inches	2¾
Thickness, minimum, inches	1⅝
Holes for fiber:	
Depth, approximately, inch	⅝
Number of holes, minimum	120
Fiber:	
Weight, minimum, ounces	5.6
Length, clear of block, minimum, inches	2.0
Handle:	
Length, minimum, inches	51
Diameter, except at tapered end, inches	1⅛ ± 1/16

3.6 Marking. The block and handle of each brush shall be marked with the contractor's name or trademark and with the stock number (see 6.4).

3.7 Workmanship. The brushes and handles shall be free from defects which affect their appearance or which might impair their serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Contractor's inspection responsibility. The supplier is responsible for the performance of all examination and test requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the examinations and tests set forth in the specification where such are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 *Lot.* All brushes of the same type presented at one time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of inspection and tests.

4.2.2 *Sampling for inspection.*

4.2.2.1 *Civil agencies.* Unless otherwise specified in the invitation for bids, a random sample of brushes shall be taken for inspection from each lot of brushes in accordance with table II.

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TABLE II.—*Sampling for inspection*

Number of brushes in lot	Number of brushes in sample	Acceptance number (defectives)	Rejection number (defectives)
65 and under	7	0	1
66 to 180	25	1	2
181 to 300	35	2	3
301 to 500	50	3	4
501 to 800	75	4	5
801 to 1,300	110	6	7
1,301 and over	150	8	9

TABLE III.—*Sampling for tests*

Number of brushes in lot	Number of brushes in sample	Acceptance number (nonconforming)	Rejection number (nonconforming)
180 and under	2	0	1
181 to 500	3	0	1
501 to 1300	5	0	1
1301 to 3200	7	0	1
3201 to 8000	10	0	1
8001 and over	15	1	2

4.2.2.2 *Military agencies.* Sampling for inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL–STD–105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter. The acceptable quality levels (AQL's), expressed in defects per 100 units, and inspection levels shall be as follows:

For examination in—	Inspection levels	AQL's
4.3.3.1	II	2.5
4.3.3.2	L–2	2.5
4.3.3.3	II	4.0

Not more than one brush shall be drawn from any one container of the type offered for inspection for visual and dimensional characteristics. The sample unit shall be one brush (type I) or one brush and one handle (type II), as applicable.

4.2.2.2.1 *Packing and marking.* The sample unit for examination of packing and marking shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the lot.

4.2.3 *Sampling for test.*

4.2.3.1 *Civil agencies.* Unless otherwise specified in the invitation for bids, a random sample of brushes shall be taken for test from each lot in accordance with table III.

4.2.3.2 *Military agencies.* Sampling for tests shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL–STD–105. Five sample units shall be taken at random from each lot presented for examination with no evidence of failure to meet the minimum requirements. The sample unit shall be either one brush (type I) or one brush and one handle (type II), as applicable.

4.3 Inspection.

4.3.1 *Inspection of materials and components.* In accordance with 4.1 herein, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, tested, and examined in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified herein, or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.3.2 *Civil agencies.* Each brush in the sample for inspection, 4.2.2.1, shall be inspected for type, design, packaging, packing, marking, workmanship, dimensions of block, wood in block, number of holes in block, length of fiber out of block, length of handle, finish of block, finish of handle, and compliance with standard sample (unless otherwise specified in the invitation to bid) in the respects enumerated in 3.1.

4.3.3 *Military agencies.*

4.3.3.1 Examination of the end item for defects in design, material, appearance, and workmanship shall be as follows:

Examine	Defect
Design	Not general design illustrated in figure 1.
	Not equal to approved standard sample.
Fiber	Not 100 percent natural color palmyra fiber.
Block (all types)	Not close-grain hardwood free of defects affecting appearance and serviceability.
	Not marked with contractor's name or trademark and with the stock number.

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Examine	Defect
Block—Con.	Not smoothly sanded, filled, and finished.
	Sides not chamfered approximately ½ inch back from the edge at an angle of 45 degrees and not bored through for the handle hole.
	Holes for handle not tapered in the same ratio as the block end of the handle so as to fit the handle closely.
Staples	Not corrosion-resisting wire staples.
	Less than 0.047 inch in diameter.
Set	Fiber does not solidly fill the holes in the block.
	Fiber not securely staple-set with ½-inch wire staples straddled over the middle of the tuft and driven into the block at the bottom of the hole.
Handles (wood) Type II Brushes only.	Not close-grain hardwood free of defects affecting appearance and serviceability.
	Not marked with contractor's name or trademark and with the stock number.
	Not smoothly finished, straight, rounded at the hand end, and tapered at the block end to ¾ inch diameter in a length of 3 inches from the end.

4.3.3.2 Examination of the end item for defects in physical requirements with the exception of weight of fiber shall be as follows:

Examine	Defect
Physical requirements.	Not in conformance with the physical requirements in table I.

4.3.3.3 Examination of preparation for delivery will be made to determine that packing and marking as required by section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects will be scored as indicated below.

Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior containers).	Incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any non-conforming component; component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of case liners, container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling; bulging or distortion of containers.
Contents (exterior container).	Number per container is more or less than required.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 *Civil agencies.* Each brush in the sample for test, 4.2.3.1, shall be tested for diameter of staple wire, size of staple, depth of holes, set, and weight of fiber, 4.4.1.1.

4.4.1.1 *Weight of fiber.* The fiber shall be removed from the block and shall be conditioned for not less than 16 hours in air at a relative humidity of 50±4 percent and at a temperature of 23°±1.1° C. (73.5°±2° F.). The weight of the fiber shall be determined in the same atmosphere.

4.4.2 *Military agencies.* The end item shall be tested as described in 4.4.1.1 for weight of fiber.

4.5 Compliance criteria (civil agencies).

4.5.1 *Inspection.* Any brush in the sample for inspection failing to conform to the requirements for which the inspection was made, 4.3, shall be considered defective. If the number of defective brushes in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample specified in table II, the entire lot of brushes from which the sample was taken shall be considered to have failed to meet the requirements of this specification.

4.5.2 *Tests.* Any brush in the sample for test failing to conform to the requirements for which tests were made, 4.4, shall be considered defective. If the number of defective brushes in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample specified in table III, the entire lot of brushes from which the sample was taken shall be considered to have failed to meet the requirements of this specification.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(Fed. Std. No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and application of the various levels of packaging and packing for civil agency procurement.)

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 *Brushes.* Packaging for brushes will not be required.

5.1.2 *Handles.* Packaging for handles will not be required (5.2.2.2).

5.2 **Packing.** Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified.

5.2.1 *Level A.*

5.2.1.1 *Brushes.* Twenty-four brushes shall be packed in snug-fitting fiberboard boxes conforming to class 2, V3c or V3s, style RSC, of PPP–B–636. Arrangement of the brushes shall be 2 in length, 4 in width, and 3 deep. Boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix of the box specification. In lieu of strapping, pressure-sensitive filament tape may be used and applied in accordance with the appendix.

5.2.1.2 *Handles.* Twelve handles shall be bundled and secured with filament reinforced tape or steel strapping or round wire. Two bundles shall be completely wrapped in jute (or kenaf) burlap cloth or cotton osnaburg with ends folded. The complete wrapping shall be secured by sewing ends and side seams with strong yarn or twine.

5.2.2 *Level B.*

5.2.2.1 *Brushes.* Twenty-four units of one unit each shall be packed in a new shipping container conforming to the requirements of PPP–B–636 fiberboard box, type I (CF) or type II (SF), class I (domestic service), style RSC. Bursting strength of fiberboard used in the box construction shall be not less than 200 pounds per square inch. Closure shall be in accordance with PPP–B–636 (Appendix).

5.2.2.2 *Handles.* Twenty-four handles shall be formed into a compact bundle with all ends even, then completely wrapped in burlap, osnaburg, or similar material (cloth), ends folded and the complete wrapping secured by stitching ends and side seams with strong cotton twine. Alternatively, the 24 handles may be bundled, then completely wrapped with at least two thicknesses of 50/60 pound kraft paper. Ends shall be neatly folded and secured by taping with 50/60 pound gummed kraft tape. Side seams of wrap shall be securely taped or secured with a suitable adhesive.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Brushes and handles shall be packed in a manner to insure safe delivery and acceptance at destination. Shipping containers shall comply with the carrier rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2.4 *Standard pack (civil agency procurements).* The standard pack for brushes and handles shall be as specified in paragraphs 5.2.2.1 and 5.2.2.2 (see section 6).

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers and bundles shall be marked in accordance with MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Type required (1.2.1).

(*c*) When a standard sample is not required.

(*d*) Level of packing required if other than level C (5.2).

6.2 Standard sample. The standard sample is a reasonable facsimile of the master standard on file at the Federal Prison Industries, First and Indiana Avenue, NW., Washington 25, D.C. It is not intended that the master standard sample shall be used for the purpose of purchase or inspection of brushes, but that the master standard sample will be used by Government agencies for comparison purposes to obtain a standard sample for their own use in purchase and inspection.

6.2.1 In order that uniform standards for brushes may be maintained among various Government agencies, purchasers should for-

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ward brushes to the Federal Prison Industries for inspection and comparison in order to obtain a standard sample equal to the master standard sample; the standard sample should then be preserved by the purchaser and used in the purchase and inspection of brushes obtained under this specification.

6.3 These brushes do not keep indefinitely, their estimated life being about 6 months. No more than a 6 month's supply should, therefore, be kept on hand, and care should be taken to issue all of the old stock before commencing to issue from the new. Suitable storage space should be provided in a well-ventilated building as it is essential that these brushes be allowed to absorb moisture freely from the atmosphere to prevent the fiber from drying out and becoming brittle.

6.4 The stock numbers for the brushes covered by this specification are as follows:

Type I—7920-240-7171.

Type II—7920-240-7171 (Brush) and 7920-263-0324 (Handle) (3.6).

6.5 The level B standard pack requirements in paragraphs 5.2.2.1 and 5.2.2.2 are intended for use in procurement of stores stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot, or intermediate storage point for temporary storage and subsequent issue or shipment to eventual user.

6.6 Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Brushes, wood fibre.

Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Brushes, wood, fibre bristle.

Truckload minimum weight (W) 24.4 pounds, (W) subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

Notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTEREST:

Army—Q

Navy—S

Air Force—MOA

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